

MS Excel — 50 MCQ Assessment

Modules 1–6 · Formulas, Functions, Formatting, Lookups, Pivot Tables & Data Tools
(Excludes XLOOKUP and Flash Fill)

Module 1 – Excel Basics & Interface

Q1. What is the intersection of a row and a column in Excel called?

- A) Tab
- B) Field
- C) Range
- D) Cell

Q2. Which part of the Excel window shows the address of the currently selected cell?

- A) Status Bar
- B) Ribbon
- C) Name Box
- D) Formula Bar

Q3. What is the correct format of a cell address?

- A) Row number followed by column letter (e.g., 5B)
- B) Only the column letter
- C) Only the row number
- D) Column letter followed by row number (e.g., B5)

Q4. Which keyboard shortcut is used to save a workbook?

- A) Ctrl + P
- B) Ctrl + O
- C) Ctrl + S
- D) Ctrl + N

Q5. Which option makes long text visible within a single cell by displaying it on multiple lines?

- A) Merge Cells
- B) AutoFit
- C) Text Align
- D) Wrap Text

Q6. What is the default file extension of a modern Excel workbook?

- A) .xls
- B) .csv
- C) .docx
- D) .xlsx

Q7. To insert a new blank row above a selected row, you should

- A) Double-click the row header
- B) Press Delete
- C) Right-click the row header and choose Insert
- D) Use Paste Special

Q8. Which number format displays the value 0.25 as 25%?

- A) Currency
- B) Scientific
- C) Percentage
- D) Accounting

Q9. Which tab on the Ribbon is primarily used to apply font, alignment, and border formatting to cells?

- A) Home
- B) Data
- C) Insert
- D) View

Module 2 – Editing, Navigation & View Tools

Q10. Paste Special allows a user to paste only specific parts of copied data, such as

- A) Only comments
- B) Only cell colors
- C) Values, formulas, or formats only
- D) Only chart objects

Q11. The small square at the bottom-right corner of a selected cell, used to drag and fill data, is called the

- A) AutoFit Marker
- B) Selection Handle
- C) Cell Anchor
- D) Fill Handle

Q12. Which keyboard shortcut opens the Find and Replace dialog box?

- A) Ctrl + E
- B) Ctrl + R
- C) Ctrl + F5
- D) Ctrl + H

Q13. Which feature keeps header rows or columns visible on screen while you scroll through the rest of the sheet?

- A) Page Break Preview
- B) Split View
- C) Freeze Panes
- D) Group Rows

Q14. What is the main difference between Sort and Filter in Excel?

- A) Filter rearranges rows, Sort hides rows
- B) There is no difference
- C) Sort hides data, Filter deletes data
- D) Sort rearranges rows permanently, while Filter temporarily hides rows that don't match criteria

Q15. When you hide a column in Excel, what happens to the data inside it?

- A) The data stays intact but is not visible
- B) The data is permanently deleted
- C) The data is converted to text
- D) The data is moved to a new sheet

Module 3 – Formulas, References & Functions

Q16. Every formula in Excel must begin with which symbol?

- A) \$ (dollar sign)
- B) = (equals sign)
- C) # (hash sign)
- D) @ (at sign)

Q17. In a cell reference such as \$A\$1, what does the dollar sign (\$) do?

- A) Formats the cell as currency
- B) Converts the value to a percentage
- C) Marks the cell as an error
- D) Locks the row and column so the reference does not change when copied

Q18. Which function is used to add up a range of numeric values?

- A) TOTAL()
- B) PLUS()
- C) SUM()
- D) ADD()

Q19. Which function counts only the cells in a range that contain numbers?

- A) COUNTIF()
- B) COUNTBLANK()
- C) COUNTA()
- D) COUNT()

Q20. Which function counts all non-empty cells in a range, regardless of whether they contain text or numbers?

- A) COUNTA()
- B) COUNT()
- C) COUNTBLANK()
- D) SUM()

Q21. Which function counts the number of empty cells in a range?

- A) COUNTBLANK()
- B) COUNTA()
- C) ISBLANK()
- D) COUNT()

Q22. What does the formula =ROUND(154.567, 2) return?

- A) 154.57
- B) 154.5
- C) 155
- D) 154.56

Q23. To calculate 18% GST on a price stored in cell A2, which formula is correct?

- A) =A2+18
- B) =18%/A2
- C) =A2/18%
- D) =A2*18%

Q24. A mixed cell reference such as A\$1 means

- A) Neither the row nor the column is locked
- B) The reference points to another worksheet
- C) The row is locked (absolute) while the column can change (relative)
- D) Both the row and column are locked

Module 4 – Logical Functions

Q25. What are the three arguments of the IF() function, in order?

- A) Range, criteria, sum range
- B) Logical test, value if true, value if false
- C) Value if true, value if false, logical test
- D) Cell, format, result

Q26. Which logical function returns TRUE only when every condition supplied to it is TRUE?

- A) OR()
- B) IF()
- C) AND()
- D) NOT()

Q27. Which logical function returns TRUE if at least one of the supplied conditions is TRUE?

- A) IFS()
- B) NOT()
- C) AND()
- D) OR()

Q28. Which function reverses a logical value, turning TRUE into FALSE and vice versa?

- A) AND()
- B) IFERROR()
- C) NOT()
- D) OR()

Q29. SUMIF() adds up values in a range that meet

- A) No condition at all
- B) Only numeric conditions
- C) A single specified condition
- D) Two or more conditions always

Q30. COUNTIF() is used to

- A) Count the number of cells that meet a given condition
- B) Sum cells that meet a given condition
- C) Average cells that meet a given condition
- D) Delete cells that meet a given condition

Q31. What does the IFERROR() function do?

- A) Highlights all errors in red
- B) Returns a specified custom value if a formula results in an error, otherwise returns the formula's result
- C) Deletes cells containing errors
- D) Automatically fixes formula errors

Module 5 – Formatting, Validation, Charts & Printing

Q32. Conditional Formatting is used to

- A) Automatically highlight or format cells based on a rule you define
- B) Protect a worksheet with a password
- C) Merge multiple cells together
- D) Permanently change the underlying data value

Q33. A drop-down list of allowed entries for a cell is created using

- A) Data > Data Validation
- B) Home > Conditional Formatting
- C) Insert > Table
- D) Review > Protect Sheet

Q34. Which built-in tool removes duplicate rows from a dataset?

- A) Sort & Filter
- B) Freeze Panes
- C) Remove Duplicates (found on the Data tab)
- D) Text to Columns

Q35. Text to Columns is primarily used to

- A) Merge several columns into one
- B) Change text color across a column
- C) Split data in a single column into multiple columns based on a delimiter
- D) Convert numbers into text automatically

Q36. Which chart type is generally best for showing a trend over time?

- A) Pie chart
- B) Bar chart
- C) Scatter chart
- D) Line chart

Q37. Which chart type is best suited to show each category's proportion of a whole?

- A) Line chart
- B) Pie chart
- C) Column chart
- D) Area chart

Q38. On which Ribbon tab would you set the Print Area before printing a worksheet?

- A) Page Layout
- B) Insert
- C) Home
- D) Review

Module 6 – Lookup Functions & Pivot Tables

Q39. VLOOKUP searches for a matching value in

- A) The last row of a range
- B) The first (leftmost) column of a specified range
- C) The first row of a range only

D) Any column of a range

Q40. HLOOKUP searches for a matching value in

- A) A named range only
- B) The first column of a range
- C) The last column of a range
- D) The first (top) row of a specified range

Q41. In VLOOKUP, setting the last argument to FALSE (or 0) means

- A) Excel will search from right to left
- B) Excel will look for an approximate match only
- C) Excel will look for an exact match only
- D) Excel will ignore the lookup value

Q42. Why is the INDEX() + MATCH() combination often preferred over VLOOKUP() for complex lookups?

- A) It automatically removes duplicates
- B) It is the only function that works with numbers
- C) It can look in any direction, including to the left of the lookup column, and is more flexible
- D) It does not require a lookup value

Q43. A PivotTable is best used for

- A) Printing worksheets
- B) Formatting cell borders
- C) Validating data entry
- D) Quickly summarizing and analyzing large amounts of data

Q44. A Slicer, when added to a PivotTable, allows you to

- A) Password-protect the workbook
- B) Visually filter the PivotTable's data with clickable buttons
- C) Merge two PivotTables into one
- D) Change the chart type automatically

Data Tools – Consolidate, What-If Analysis, Group & Subtotal

Q45. Which Excel feature combines and summarizes data from several separate sheets into a single summary sheet?

- A) Subtotal
- B) Consolidate
- C) Data Validation
- D) Group

Q46. Goal Seek is used to

- A) Combine data from multiple worksheets
- B) Find the input value needed to achieve a specific target result in a formula
- C) Remove duplicate entries from a table
- D) Automatically format cells based on their value

Q47. Scenario Manager allows a user to

- A) Freeze rows and columns
- B) Automatically correct formula errors

C) Create Pivot Charts

D) Build and compare multiple sets of input values (such as Best Case, Most Likely, Worst Case) and see their outcomes

Q48. A Data Table (one-variable or two-variable) is primarily used for

A) Sorting a list alphabetically

B) Removing blank rows

C) Testing how a result changes as one or two input values vary, i.e. sensitivity analysis

D) Adding headers and footers

Q49. The Group/Ungroup feature under the Data tab allows you to

A) Apply conditional formatting to a range

B) Collapse and expand related rows or columns to show more or less detail

C) Merge two workbooks into one file

D) Convert text to numbers

Q50. The Subtotal command automatically

A) Deletes all blank cells in a column

B) Creates a drop-down validation list

C) Locks all formula cells from editing

D) Inserts summary rows (such as sums or averages) for grouped data and creates outline levels